POCKET GUIDE

WHAT TO DO IN ORLANDO?

PRACTICAL TIPS,
MUST-SEE ATTRACTIONS
AND UNFORGETTABLE
EXPERIENCES!



- ITINERARIES FOR EVERY TRAVELER
- STUNNING PHOTOS
- MONEY-SAVING TIPS
- EXPERIENCES THAT STAY IN YOUR MEMORY

PLAN. DISCOVER. LIVE ORLANDO! ♥

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FIRST THINGS FIRST

Orlando runs on a different clock

Orlando isn't a city; it's an archipelago of worlds. Every park, every outlet, every beach is its own island, separated from the next by 20, 30, 40 minutes of highway. The question that decides how big your trip will be isn't "what to do," it's **how much time you're willing to lose getting there**.

Rideshare seems convenient until the fare triples as you leave the park at 10 p.m., with a tired family and no car available nearby. Having your own car changes that equation: the itinerary is yours, the schedule is yours, the trunk is yours.

> ***"The best vacations are the ones where the clock works in your favor."***

To put it all together, this guide looks at Orlando from four angles:

Time shows how much of your day each trip takes, distance reveals what's really nearby, routes suggest the best order for fitting in parks, shopping and the beach, and seasons explain how weather and crowds change the experience throughout the year. Together, they form this guide's decision map.

Time
how much each trip takes

Distance
what's close to what

Routes
the best path between stops

Seasons
weather and crowds through the year

Magic Kingdom

> ***Are you ready to discover the secret behind the world's most famous fireworks show?***

Behind every castle tower there's an invisible script: character times, fireworks angles and parades that change without notice. If you arrive by rideshare, you're at the mercy of someone else's schedule. If you arrive in your own car, you decide when to get in line and when to leave, without waiting on anyone.

38 min
from downtown Orlando

3 parking lots
TTC with free tram

Before 8 a.m.
to catch the park empty



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> ***"Arriving 40 minutes before opening changes the whole experience, and that's only possible by car."***

Epcot

> ***What if you could taste France, toast in Mexico and see the future, all before dinner?***

World Showcase is Orlando's most "walkable" park: nearly 1.2 miles (2 km) circling a lake with 11 countries. Riding there and back by rideshare means depending on surge pricing right at the dinner rush, the exact moment prices skyrocket.

32 min
from downtown Orlando

1.2 mi (1.9 km)
walking around the lake

Late afternoon
for the nighttime show on the lake



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> ***"Surge pricing climbs right at 8 p.m., the time everyone wants to leave Epcot."***

Hollywood Studios

> ***Ever thought about piloting the Millennium Falcon before your breakfast coffee gets cold?***

The park's most popular attractions open virtual queue reservations at 7 a.m., from home, from the car, from wherever you are. But the race against the clock doesn't end there: if you get a time slot but can't get to the gate quickly, you lose your spot anyway.

35 min
from downtown Orlando

7 a.m. sharp
virtual queue opens

30-min buffer
recommended before you reach the gate



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> ***"The virtual queue won't wait for your Uber to arrive. Your own car will."***

Animal Kingdom

> ***What's the only park in the world where the African savanna opens before the sun has really come up?***

Animals are most active in the first hours of the day, before Florida's heat sends them to rest in the shade. That means being at the gate at 7 a.m., a time when rideshare apps charge early-morning surge rates and cut back the number of available cars.

40 min
from downtown Orlando

2nd-largest park
in the world by area

Before 9 a.m.
to see the animals active



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> ***"A good safari is an early-morning safari, and the wee hours are when fares run high."***

Universal Studios

> ***Ready to step into your own movie, without ever waiting in a real ticket line?***

Universal Studios and Islands of Adventure are just minutes apart, connected by CityWalk. If you have a car, you cross from one to the other in minutes and still park in the same spot all day. If you depend on a rideshare app, you pay for double rides, there and back, just to switch parks.

22 min
from downtown Orlando

1 parking garage
serves both parks + CityWalk

Opening time
to catch Diagon Alley empty



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> ***"One parking garage, two parks. That's how you win back vacation time."***

Islands of Adventure

> ***What if the most thrilling park in Orlando were right around the corner from your hotel?***

Snow-covered Hogsmeade, roller coasters that really take off and the Jurassic Park River Adventure call for re-entries throughout the day: a plunge, a break to dry off, and back in. Only those with a car in the parking lot can make this back-and-forth at no extra cost and without waiting on anyone.

22 min
from downtown Orlando

5 themed islands
in a single park

Bring a change of clothes
for the water rides



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> ***"Got soaked on the Jurassic Park River Adventure? With a car, a fresh change of clothes is just a few steps away."***

Outlets and Shopping

> ***Did you know Orlando has two of the biggest outlets in the United States, just minutes from each other?***

Orlando International Premium Outlets and Premium Outlets International Drive add up to hundreds of designer stores with up to 65% off. The catch? Heavy shopping bags don't mix with shared rides, cramped back seats and strangers in the carpool. With your own car, your purchases go straight into the trunk, and you can still fit a water park into the same day.

15–25 min
from downtown / International Drive

2 outlets
just minutes apart

Free trunk space
to store your purchases securely



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> ***"From outlet to water park in the same day: only those with a car can pull off that combination stress-free."***

Distances that cost time

Orlando looks small on the map and gigantic on the clock. These are the real distances from the International Drive area, and what each one means when your transportation isn't your own.

DESTINATION	DISTANCE	BY CAR	WITHOUT YOUR OWN CAR
Magic Kingdom	13 mi (21 km)	38 min	high fare · +40 min
Universal Orlando	8 mi (13 km)	22 min	wait + 2 rides
Orlando Premium Outlets	5.6 mi (9 km)	15 min	trunk space unavailable
ICON Park	4.3 mi (7 km)	13 min	high fare at night
Cocoa Beach	56 mi (90 km)	1 hr 5 min	nearly impossible without a car

> *"Every minute spent waiting for a car that isn't yours is a minute less inside the park."*



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

Best routes of the day

A fixed itinerary is the enemy of a good trip. With a car, you change plans in the middle of the day, without asking anyone's permission. Three combinations that only work with freedom behind the wheel:

ROUTE 01 · SHOPPING + WATER

Outlets in the morning, water park in the afternoon

Stash your purchases in the trunk and head straight to the wave pool, without going back to the hotel and without waiting for a ride.

ROUTE 02 · TWO PARKS, ONE DAY

Universal in the morning, Islands of Adventure in the afternoon

Just minutes apart: with the car in the same parking lot all day, switching is instant.

ROUTE 03 · BEACH GETAWAY

A full day in Cocoa Beach, no need to rely on a tour

1 hr 5 min of easy driving to the Atlantic. Without a car, this route simply doesn't exist on your itinerary.



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

Seasons and weather

Florida doesn't have a harsh winter, but it does have seasons of park crowds, rain and heat. Choose yours with your eyes open.

JAN – MAR

Mild and calm

Shorter lines, pleasant temperatures. Great for long days by car between parks and outlets.

APR – JUN

Rising heat

Start early, take shelter from the sun at midday. Having your own air-conditioned car becomes an essential comfort.

JUL – SEP

Peak season and rain showers

Quick rain late in the afternoon, almost every day. Outrunning it is easy by car, much harder on the sidewalk.

OCT – DEC

Events and year-end lights

Decorated parks draw crowds at night. Getting out of a packed parking lot quickly is where having your own car pays off.



What to wear

The right clothes save time. And time is Orlando's most expensive currency.

Dry parks	Light, light-colored clothes, comfortable sneakers, a cap and sunscreen. Keep a jacket in the car for the evening, which is cooler than it seems.
Water parks	Swimsuit under your clothes, trail sandals and a dry change of clothes waiting in the car for the ride back.
Fall/winter nights	A light jacket does the trick, since Florida gets chillier at night than tourists expect.
Outlet day	Clothes that are easy to try on over what you're wearing, and comfortable shoes, because a good outlet means walking miles.

> ***"A forgotten jacket in Orlando is no big deal: with a car, it's always just a parking lot away."***



FLAVORS

Where to eat well, away from the lines

Orlando's best restaurants are rarely inside the parks: they're spread across neighborhoods 10, 15 or 20 minutes away. Without a car, that option simply disappears from the map.

Restaurant Row

Dozens of options on Sand Lake Road, 12 minutes from I-Drive, practically out of reach without a car at night.

CityWalk

Nightlife and dining next to Universal, where having your own parking makes it easier to stay out later.

Winter Park

A charming neighborhood 30 minutes from the tourist center, an outing that only exists with your own car.

Local grocery stores

Buy breakfast items and save on every meal, something impossible to carry without a trunk.



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

AFTER THE SUN GOES DOWN

ICON Park & nightlife

The 400-foot (122 m) Ferris wheel lights up the International Drive skyline every night. Around it: an aquarium, mini golf, interactive museums and an entire promenade that only comes alive after dinner, right when rideshare fares spike.

13 min
from downtown Orlando

400 ft (122 m)
tall Ferris wheel

Park once
and walk between attractions



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

THE SEA IS YOURS, TOO

Beaches just a road trip away

Orlando has no coastline, but it's a little over an hour from it. Cocoa Beach and New Smyrna Beach are full-day outings, with no tour package and no fixed schedule to follow.

1 hr 5 min

Cocoa Beach

The most popular beach near Orlando, with surf spots and an iconic pier.

1 hr 20 min

New Smyrna Beach

Quieter, great for families who want to escape the hustle of the parks for a day.



Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> *"Without a car, the beach becomes a rushed tour package with a set time. With a car, you just decide when to go."*

Before you go

DOCUMENTS FOR DRIVING

- ✓ Valid passport
- ✓ Valid driver's license
- ✓ International Driving Permit (recommended)
- ✓ International credit card
- ✓ Confirmed reservation from the rental company

PACKING CHECKLIST

- ✓ Sunscreen and cap
- ✓ Swimsuit and a dry change of clothes
- ✓ Light jacket for the evening
- ✓ Power bank for your phone
- ✓ Reusable water bottle

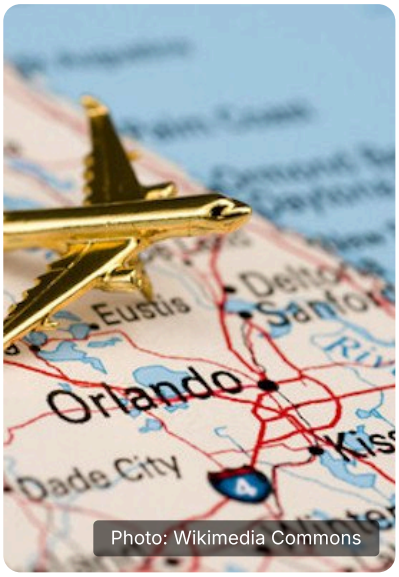


Photo: Wikimedia Commons

> ***"The one item that changes everything on the list? The keys to your very own car."***

SUMMIT
RENT A CAR

YOUR SUMMIT JOURNEY

The best vacations are the ones with no hassle.

Freedom to experience Orlando at your own pace, hassle-free.

Renting a car is the most comfortable way to get around Orlando: you choose the time and length of every trip, and the trunk carries your shopping and souvenirs safely. At most hotels, parking is free, at no extra cost.

Orlando's avenues were designed to welcome tourists year-round: wide, well-marked and with little traffic. International Drive concentrates the most popular parks, hotels and outlets, and Interstate 4 connects the city to Daytona Beach, Tampa, Winter Park and Kissimmee within a short drive.

So, to take all your trips with safety, peace of mind and comfort, book your car 100% online with Summit. We offer a wide variety of vehicle categories to suit every taste and need.

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